

58) Show that $p|(q|r)$ and $(p|q)|r$ are not equivalent, so that the logical operator $|$ is not associative.

Soln: $p|(q|r) \equiv p|(\neg(q \wedge r))$ (By Ex-51)
 $\equiv p|(\neg q \vee \neg r)$ (By 1st De Morgan's Law)
 $\equiv \neg(p \wedge (\neg q \vee \neg r))$ (By Ex-51)
 $\equiv \neg p \vee \neg(\neg q \vee \neg r)$ (By 1st De Morgan's Law)
 $\equiv \neg p \vee (\neg(\neg q) \wedge \neg(\neg r))$ (By 2nd De Morgan's Law)
 $\equiv \neg p \vee (q \wedge r)$ (By Double negation Law)
 $\equiv (\neg p \vee q) \wedge (\neg p \vee r)$ (1st Distributive Law)

$(p|q)|r \equiv \neg(p|q) \vee r$ (By Ex-51)
 $\equiv \neg(\neg p \vee q) \vee r$ (By 1st De Morgan's Law)
 $\equiv \neg(\neg p \vee q) \wedge r$ (By Ex-51)
 $\equiv \neg(\neg p \vee q) \vee \neg r$ (By 1st De Morgan's Law)
 $\equiv \neg(\neg(\neg p)) \vee \neg r$ (By 1st De Morgan's Law)
 $\equiv (p \wedge \neg r) \vee \neg r$ (Double-negation Law)
 $\equiv (p \wedge \neg r) \vee (\neg p \vee \neg r)$ (1st commutative Law)
 $\equiv (p \wedge \neg r) \vee (\neg p \vee \neg r)$ (1st Distributive Law)

~~$(p|q)|r \equiv \neg(p|q) \vee r$~~

p	q	r	$\neg p$	$\neg p \vee q$	$\neg p \vee r$	$(\neg p \vee q) \wedge (\neg p \vee r)$	$\neg r$	$\neg p \vee \neg r$	$\neg p \vee q$
T	T	T	F	T	T	T	F	T	T
T	T	F	F	T	F	F	T	T	F
T	F	T	F	F	T	F	F	T	T
T	F	F	F	F	F	F	T	T	T
F	T	T	T	T	T	T	F	T	F
F	T	F	T	T	T	T	F	T	F
F	F	T	T	T	T	T	T	T	T
F	F	F	T	T	T	T	T	T	T

$\neg(p \vee r) \wedge (\neg p \vee q)$

T
F
F
F
F
F
F
F

It's easy to see from the truth table that $(\neg p \vee q) \wedge (\neg p \vee r)$ is not logically equivalent to $\neg(p \vee r) \wedge (\neg p \vee q)$. $\therefore p|(q|r)$ is not logically equivalent to $(p|q)|r$ $\square$.